Japan + Pacific Dept

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THE FRENCH AMBASSADOR told me this evening that he took a very unfavourable view of Mr. Yoshida's letter to Mr. Dulles about Japan's relations with China. It would be likely to provoke Communist China and might well have unfavourable effects in Indo-China.

I told the Ambassador that we shared his view that this was a disturbing development. It was not even in the best interests of the United States, on a long term view.

I explained to the Ambassador the understanding which had been reached between Mr. Morrison and Mr. Dulles before the signature of the Treaty and the line which the Secretary of State had taken with Mr. Acheson in Paris and in Rome and with Mr. Acheson and Mr. Dulles recently in Washington. For his own confidential information I said that the Secretary of State had known of the existence of this letter but that the text of it had not been given to him in Washington nor had it been discussed.

The Ambassador asked what action we were taking. I told him of the line which Sir E. Dening had been authorised to take in reply to questions. I also said that Sir O. Franks would probably be letting it be known in Washington that we did not think that this was a very good way to conduct business.

17th January, 1952.

Top to: Japan and Pacific Department
Copies to: Secretary of State
Minister of State
Lord Reading
Mr. Nutting
Sir R. Makins
Sir P. Dixon
Mr. R.H. Scott
China and Korea Department

Flimsy copy: Sir O. Harvey, Paris

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